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THE GAME OF 42 · FOR THE VISION FISH

The Hitchhiker's Timeline

The story of the path: a narrative for the Vision Fish

DON'T PANIC

There is a version of the future that almost everyone is quietly building, and it goes like this: one model, one centre, one moment when the great machine wakes up and begins to decide things on our behalf; and, underneath that, one enormous lake into which all of our data is poured, stirred and mined for someone else's benefit. It is a tidy story. It is also the story we are refusing to tell.

What follows is the other story. It is the path a small group of people (they call themselves the *mice*: Robbie, Max, Dave and Mitch, with Henry on brand) have spent nineteen long working sessions mapping out, milestone by milestone, on a wall of sticky notes. They ran every step through the same five questions (*who cares, who is involved, what changes, what's the proof, and what makes it feel real*), and what emerged was not a product roadmap so much as a wager about how the next two years could go if you bet on plurality instead of a centre. If you are reading this, it is because we think you might want to place that bet with us. We call people like you the Vision Fish, and there is a place in all of this with your name on it. But first, the story.

A word of honesty before we begin, because the whole culture is built on it: these were *visioning* sessions. The dates here are intentions, not promises; the numbers (forty-two thousand users, four-point-two million, forty-two billion tokens) are motifs and targets, not forecasts. The team plans far past what it has actually built and then works backwards toward today. Wherever something is a hope rather than a fact, this telling says so plainly. It is, after all, the kind of project that prints *Don't Panic* on the cover and means it.

The wager

The destination has a name: the **poly-singularity**. Where the common future bends toward one of everything, this one bends toward many: a federation of local sovereignties, each holding its own boundary, its own model, its own voice, that nonetheless folds together into a single global mutual without any of them giving up what makes them distinct. The inversion at its heart is as much economic as technical. In the lake model, value comes from pooling everyone's data and mining it. Here, value comes from the opposite move, from *keeping the boundary*. Privacy stops being a cost to be managed and becomes the very thing that produces worth. **Privacy realised as value.** Many singularities, one commons, no centre. Everything else in this story is the path that earns it.

The project speaks in *Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy* throughout, and the vocabulary does real work: it is the operating system of the culture as much as the code is. The number 42 runs through everything on purpose: forty-two hours pledged, forty-two thousand pounds donated, forty-two Vision Fish, forty-two venues, forty-two assemblies. There is Marvin, the flagship AI character, who comes in two sizes (a full model and a "baby" Marvette that runs on a Raspberry Pi), and the pairing of Eddie, the cheerful local shipboard computer, with Deep Thought, the vast machine in the cloud, which is how the team keeps the argument between local and centralised intelligence honest from both sides. And beneath it all sits the *trust*

graph: lay a map of what someone knows over a record of what they have promised and delivered, and the relationship between the two *is* trust, made visible. Much of the next two years is simply the work of making that graph real.

The journey

It begins quietly, on the fourth of July, 2026, with a declaration. Robbie's founding text goes out, not as a single canonical document but as several poetic translations of one another, and the decision that defines it is restraint. No splashy launch, no paid advertising; just a teaser sent privately to the people the team actually wants in the room. The surprising thing the mice keep returning to is that the people most likely to care are the *no-gens*, the ones who reject generative AI altogether, and they may care more than the enthusiasts. Success here is not measured in reach but in *serendipity*: the number of real conversations the invitation conjures. And from the very first day there is a defensive posture, only half in jest, called *Bushido*: protecting the commons with the right lawyers and the right humour rather than with aggression.

Through August, out of sight, the engine gets built. This is the unglamorous half (the Pan-Galactic Time Bank and its energy accounting, the plumbing kept deliberately under the hood) and its more public twin, Hitchhiker TV and the live trust-graph visualisation, which is the first time the declaration's words become something you can actually *see*. The magic the team is chasing is small and specific: a trust-graph tetrahedron that changes, live, from real data, "like growing your tamagotchi," someone says, only with the fate of a civilisation faintly attached.

Then the season opens. The autumn is the **Don't Panic Tour**, announced at Burning Man, timed to the university term, running on a 24/7 Hitchhiker Radio station and the first wave of guides, with students in halls as the engine of a hundred small local events. It is, frankly, a bid to pull younger and more various energy into a base that has grown a little grey, and it hardens one rule that turns out to matter enormously later: a group cannot truly speak for the world unless it holds real diversity of age and belief and temperament, so the old must recruit the young and the young the old. Around the same time the project goes looking for credibility and capital at **Web Summit** in Lisbon: it ships its app, stands on a real stage as a real project for the first time, and signs up its first Patron Fish, the funders who give or invest forty-two thousand and, just as importantly, lend their prestige. It is also where Hitchhikers get on-chain financial privacy for the first time, not as a way to hide money but as a way to *keep a boundary*: the wager made concrete, early.

The fifth of November brings the **Don't Panic Festival**: a decentralised celebration spread across forty-two locations, which you can join simply by cooking at home, tuning into the radio, and saying the magic words. The tone is the whole product (a gleeful celebration of doom, curated like Super Bowl adverts, every cosmic catastrophe resolving on a calm, cabin-crew "Don't Panic"), and beneath the absurdism sit

entirely real causes: regenerative farming, food security. The festival's lasting gift is a reframe: *Don't Panic is a governance meme, not an event meme*, something you can use on a wet Tuesday, in a pitch, in a risk review. Through the cold winter that follows come the token launch and a run of hackathons to keep the builders warm, and then, in January, the **Game Jam**, a global, decentralised challenge to build Hitchhiker games on a shared substrate, with the lovely inversion that other game-makers are an audience too: Marvin can wander into *their* worlds as a guide.

By February the script flips. **Groundhog Day** turns deliberately toward institutions (Davos-grade partners and their risk managers, in the project's own decentralised "un-Davos"), and it is the moment the Patron Fish commitments turn into money actually in the bank, and the project stops feeling like an art experiment and starts feeling like a serious, if unusual, business. The discipline underneath it is stated plainly and repeatedly: *bad money is bad money*. Vet every source, lean on your advisors, and be ready to say no to capital that comes with strings. Then spring arrives and with it the cultural turn: Rose Day reframing an old Barcelona tradition as a mutual-credit exchange where the rose is a promise and the book is knowledge; a No-Gen event for the writers and storytellers who want nothing to do with generated work; and, at its centre, **Myspace Rewilded**, the milestone where the philosophy finally becomes touchable. Here everyone who has come this far can vibe-code their own interface onto one shared substrate (many ugly, weird, beautiful, individual expressions of a single thing), and the deep doubt the team is trying to overcome is belief itself: people love the ideals but suspect they cannot really be built. The answer is to let them *see it and use it today*.

All of this bends toward a single point ("the beam is Christmas," as Dave puts it), and that point is the **Annual Galactic Meeting** on the fourth of July, 2027. It is the great convergence: one party across forty-two venues, somewhere between an awards night, a future-casting session and something genuinely strange, and the moment the founding work is handed into mutual ownership. The headline is the Improbable Lottery (at least one guaranteed prize of forty-two thousand pounds, with the cheerful rule that to win you have to turn up), and the most important ritual is Burn Night, when the fluid contributions of the year are locked into something solid and the watching world thinks, for the first time, *these people are actually serious*. The measure of whether it worked is unexpectedly tender: money given away without it ever feeling like a loss, and forty-two venues all choosing, independently, to organise for the same date.

The destination

Past the AGM the plan thins into the genuinely aspirational, and this is where its deepest intent lives. In late 2027 comes **Sovereign Compute**: a real attempt to knit home labs and community data centres into a peer-to-peer network that could, credibly, begin to out-compute the great centralised models. The honest tension is named rather than hidden (you cannot easily build an alternative to the frontier labs while also

asking them to be your partners), and the resolution is one of sequence and ceremony: provoke first, then route the labs through citizen assemblies and a trust ritual before they are ever allowed near the commons.

And then, in 2028, the whole story arrives at the **poly-singularity**. The early sessions imagined it as two separate moonshots, but they are really two faces of one event. The first is *governance*: a planetary structure of forty-two assemblies in which not only people but nature, the young, and the unrecognised nations of the world get a real seat: deliberation, not a survey, a chosen assembly meeting across a year and producing answers you can actually sit and listen to, until the people who used to talk grandly about *the* singularity begin to find it a little embarrassing. The second face is *the answers*: a global, Live-Aid-scale moment in which the frontier labs bequeath billions of tokens and a pool of compute to a neutral third space, where credentialed Hitchhikers work the great questions in the open, and where the way in is not money but a pledge of forty-two hours of your time, so that reputation and learning lead. Its truest proof, they decided, would be emotional: people should probably cry.

Put the two faces together and you have the thing the whole timeline was for. Every person and every community holds their own boundary and their own model, and the plurality of those sovereign computes federates into one mutual that can think about the planet's largest questions *without anyone surrendering their ground*. It is, very deliberately, not a data lake; the worth comes from privacy kept, not data pooled. The largest mutual the Hitchhikers can imagine, grown from the smallest local sovereignties. Many singularities, and no centre at all.

There is more held off to the side, what the team calls being “on the 42,” an off-calendar space for the ideas that don't fit the line yet: embassies and co-living built on real-world assets, a global apprenticeship exchange to “feed the brain” of Deep Thought, post-quantum cryptography reframed as the very Hitchhiker virtue of staying nimble, a long-held dream of a local-AI partnership with Apple, a Marvin robot, an Olympic news-jack. They are not promises. They are the direction the compass points when the calendar runs out.

What “real” means, and where you come in

It is worth saying what this team means by success, because it is not the usual thing. It is not followers; it is serendipity: the inbound meeting, the door knocked from the outside, the stranger at a conference already pitching your idea back to you. It is emotion: the Live-Aid test, the thing you can finally mention at a family dinner without anyone laughing. It is the map filling in with pins, nodes coming online, forks multiplying. And it is money that does not feel extractive: giving to people without it feeling as though something has been taken from the rest of us. The team grows, by deliberate choice, *at the speed of trust*: it would rather move slowly and keep its integrity than go viral and lose the plot.

Which brings us, finally, to you. A Vision Fish is not a spectator. The early milestones are exactly where your judgement and your network matter most (an introduction, a stage, a willingness to lend your name

to a founding-donor wall), and the later ones are where that early trust compounds into governance and compute at a planetary scale. The wager is the one we opened with: that a federation of kept boundaries, each holding its own model and its own voice, can become a single global mutual in which privacy is realised as value, and that this is a far better future than the one enormous lake everyone else is so busy, so quietly, building.

If that is a future you would like to be part of, then this is the shape of the next two years, and there is a place in it with your name already on it.

Don't Panic.